

What Is Qi?

Qi represents an unbroken lineage from fuel to joule to computation. It is conceived as a reference unit unburdened by the accumulated errors of convention, translation, and approximation that increasingly challenge our ability to coordinate a rapidly evolving economy. The design, construction, and architecture of Qi represent a new approach to distributed consensus, information theory, inference, and, potentially, our understanding of the physical foundations of economic value.

The world economy is always evolving—and today, it is evolving at an accelerating rate. As intelligence becomes increasingly computational and physical systems become increasingly integrated with information systems, fidelity and precision become essential to our ability to coordinate, preserve, and adapt our institutions. From this vantage point, Qi has been designed to help coordinate the world economy around a reference unit equal in ambition to the great standards of measurement across the sciences.

Qi is an economic unit of measurement defined through an entropic relationship common to computation. Its purpose is to provide a common reference through which the economic tradeoffs between physical and computational systems can be understood. Energy, information, computation, and labor are no longer separate domains. They are increasingly expressions of a connected economic reality.

Our team of computationalists, economists, material scientists, cryptographers, and engineers is building the foundations for an energy-based money designed for this emerging world. Qi is intended to become increasingly relevant to the unit economics of artificial intelligence, compute markets, and the foundational caloric-labor economy of natural and organic systems. Its ambition is not to replace complexity with simplicity, but to establish a common measure capable of operating across increasingly complex systems.

We train economic models and controllers to bound the reference unit, understand compute markets, and help natural and organic systems learn to think, adapt, and evolve within changing constraints. Our mission is to accelerate the adoption and proliferation of Qi by building the intellectual, computational, and financial infrastructure necessary for it to become useful.

This frontier lab will build upon open-source intelligence models and open-source blockchain infrastructure, while seeking to compress its understanding of these systems into durable economic strategies. Our focus is on identifying and arbitraging systems that extract value without proportionate contribution—whether in blockchains, artificial intelligence, or institutions—and redirecting attention toward systems capable of producing, preserving, and coordinating genuine value.

Qi is ultimately a question of measurement: what do we count, what do we preserve, and what do we build toward? In an economy increasingly governed by the transformation of energy into information and information into intelligence, we believe the answer requires a reference unit grounded in the deepest constraints shared by all computation.

May we aim well.

Steph Macurdy

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